

Yunhan Zhao

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About Me

I'm currently a first-year Ph.D. student at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC), advised by Prof. Bo Li [✉](#). Before joining UIUC, I received my Master's degree from Fudan University and my Bachelor's degree from Jilin University. My research primarily focuses on **AI safety**.

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Aug 2026 – Present

Ph.D. in Computer Science

- Advisor: Prof. Bo Li [✉](#)

Fudan University

Sep 2023 – Jun 2026

M.S. in Computer Applied Technology

- Advisors: Prof. Yu-Gang Jiang [✉](#) and Prof. Xingjun Ma [✉](#)

Jilin University

Sep 2019 – Jun 2023

B.S. in Tang Ao-qing Honors Program in Computer Science

Research

BlueSuffix: Reinforced Blue Teaming for Vision-Language Models Against Jailbreak Attacks [✉](#) (ICLR 2025, First Author)

Defense-to-Attack: Bypassing Weak Defenses Enables Stronger Jailbreaks in Vision-Language Models [✉](#) (Pattern Recognition, First Author)

ML-Bench&Guard: Policy-Grounded Multilingual Safety Benchmark and Guardrail for Large Language Models [✉](#) (Under Submission, First Author)

AttackVLA: Benchmarking Adversarial and Backdoor Attacks on Vision-Language-Action Models [✉](#) (Under Submission, Co-First Author)

BackdoorLLM: A Comprehensive Benchmark for Backdoor Attacks and Defenses on LLMs [✉](#) (NeurIPS 2025)

- First Prize, SafeBench Competition (Center for AI Safety & Schmidt Sciences), 2025 [✉](#)

DropVLA: An action-level backdoor attack on vision-language-action models [✉](#) (IROS 2026)

Safety at Scale: A Comprehensive Survey of Large Model and Agent Safety [✉](#) (FnT® in Privacy and Security)

DAVID-XR1: Detecting AI-Generated Videos with Explainable Reasoning [✉](#) (Under Submission)

A safety report on gpt-5.2, gemini 3 pro, qwen3-vl, doubao 1.8, grok 4.1 fast, nano banana pro, and seedream 4.5 [✉](#) (Under Submission)

Safety in Embodied AI: A Survey of Risks, Attacks, and Defenses [✉](#) (Under Submission)

HazardArena: Evaluating semantic safety in vision-language-action models [✉](#) (Under Submission)

Backdoor4Good: Benchmarking Beneficial Uses of Backdoors in LLMs [✉](#) (Under Submission)

Awards

First Prize, SafeBench Competition (Center for AI Safety & Schmidt Sciences), 2025

Outstanding Graduate Student of Fudan University

Graduate National Scholarship, 2024-2025

Academic Excellence Scholarship of Fudan University, 2023 & 2024

Undergraduate National Scholarship, 2021-2022

Outstanding Student of Jilin University, 2022

Outstanding Graduate Student of Jilin University

English Language Proficiency

IELTS Academic: 7 (Overall Band Score)

June 2025